Charles L. Sherman

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Senior Solutions Engineer

Senior Solutions Engineer with 15+ years in enterprise SaaS presales, most recently selling to Financial Services buyers across banking, insurance, and wealth management. Ranked #1 SE in North America at Qualtrics (2024) and led technical strategy on the company's largest FS deal (~$40M). Runs POCs on messy, unstructured customer and contact center data, handles security and vendor-risk reviews with regulated buyers, and builds with LLMs and MCP rather than just demoing them.

Core Competencies

Proof of Concept (POC) | Technical Discovery & Solution Design | Financial Services & Regulated Industries | Conversation & Text Analytics | Customer Experience (CX/VoC) | Security & Vendor-Risk Reviews | Integrations (SSO, SFTP, Webhooks) | Generative AI (Claude, LLMs, MCP) | AI Demo Strategy | RFP & Competitive Strategy | Executive & Value Selling | MEDDPICC | Data Analytics | Player/Coach & SE Leadership

Work Experience

Manager, Solution Engineering, Financial Services Jul 2025 – Aug 2026

Qualtrics

- Promoted to lead the Financial Services SE team after a multi-year run as its top individual contributor; managed 6 SEs as a player/coach (hired 1), personally leading demos and technical strategy on 25+ deals, about half of them large strategic accounts.
- Formulated and expanded the team's AI demo strategy, building standardized playbooks and narrative frameworks for embedded AI capabilities, plus a Financial Services playbook addressing regulatory objections and AI vendor mistrust that unlocked AI suite upsells at 5 major banking and insurance accounts.
- Built a weighted pipeline forecasting tool with Claude during a six-month internal pilot, adjusting Salesforce revenue by deal stage, AE forecast accuracy, and roadblocks; used in monthly pipeline 1:1s and rolled up into the quarterly Financial Services pipeline report.
- Built custom prospect demo surveys and dashboards with LLMs and MCP connections, and generated taxonomies for Text Analytics solutions.
- Collaborated with GTM and Sales Leadership to develop 3 new sales plays and demo strategies, expanding 2025 pipeline by 25% and driving the team to 105% of FY25 quota.

Senior Principal Solutions Engineer Sep 2019 – Jun 2025

Qualtrics

- Ranked #1 Solutions Engineer in North America for 2024 based on revenue generated, surpassing a field of 75-plus peers.
- Headed technical strategy and execution for the largest Financial Services deal in company history at approximately $40M, guiding a multi-stakeholder enterprise sales cycle, and securing a landmark company win and a subsequent $1M upsell.
- Propelled several of the largest competitive rip-and-replace wins in the Financial Services vertical, displacing incumbent CX/VoC platforms through technical evaluation strategy and value-based demonstrations.
- Ran technical discovery, solution design, POCs, and C-suite presentations for enterprise Financial Services prospects, partnering with Account Executives through the full sales cycle.
- First line on security and vendor-risk reviews with Financial Services buyers, bringing in Security or Engineering only for deep technical questions.

- Scoped and demoed integrations and workflows: HRIS data (Workday, SuccessFactors, Oracle) over SFTP, webhooks, SSO, and Slack and ServiceNow automations.
- Won a $2M ACV life insurance deal over incumbent contact center vendors by leading the conversational analytics POC, mapping survey, digital, and call data to the customer's KPIs to expose digital experience gaps driving call volume and agent knowledge gaps.
- Rescued a $3M strategic account renewal from significant adoption and technical risk, selected by executive leadership to lead the deal technically, delivering an 8-hour onsite resolution session.

Senior Evangelist, Adobe Experience Cloud May 2014 – Mar 2019

Adobe

- Served as thought leader and technical expert for the Experience Cloud globally, centered on media and advertising solutions, collaborating with Engineering, Product Management, Sales, and Product Marketing on cross-solution strategy.
- Influenced over $8M in FY18 revenue, partnering with Sales to present the Experience Cloud to enterprise marketing executives, earning recognition for a pivotal role in closing 2 $1M+ deals.
- Conceived and constructed custom demos for Adobe's largest customer conferences, including the 2018 Advertising Cloud demo featured in the Adobe Summit keynote, reaching 25,000+ people globally.
- Authored and delivered Adobe solution demos to Forrester and Gartner analysts, with 3 2018 analyst engagements propelling Adobe's 'Market Leader' designation.

Senior Sales Engineer Jan 2012 – Mar 2014

Adobe

- Guided the East Coast and Central territory teams using the Demo2Win methodology, landing some of the largest Ad Cloud deals including FedEx, CBSi, Grainger, New York Life, Angie's List, and eBay.
- Recruited, trained, and scaled the Solutions Consulting team following Adobe's acquisition of Efficient Frontier.

Additional Experience

Senior Sales Engineer

Efficient Frontier

Search advertising optimization platform; acquired by Adobe

- Steered technical sales operations across North and South America, overseeing hiring and training of new Account Executives and Sales Engineers, ahead of Adobe's acquisition of Efficient Frontier in January 2012.
- Translated the platform's portfolio-optimization engine, based on Modern Portfolio Theory, into business terms for enterprise advertisers, showing how risk/return modeling across thousands of keywords maximized return on large paid-search budgets.

Education & Certifications

Bachelor of Arts in Art History and Philosophy, Magna Cum Laude, Emory University

Qualtrics Expert Certifications: CX, EX, and Market Research | Demo2Win Certified